Technology Change Management Standard

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Owner: Technology Governance
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1. Purpose and Scope

This standard defines the mandatory controls for authorising, testing, and deploying changes to production technology services. It applies to all production changes, including application releases, infrastructure changes, and configuration changes.

2. Definitions

A "change" is any addition, modification, or removal of a production service component. An "implementer" is the individual who performs the change. An "approver" is the individual accountable for authorising the change.

3. Approval

3.1 Changes must be approved before deployment to production.

3.2 The approver must be independent of the implementing engineer. A change must not be approved by the person who implemented it.

3.3 Approval evidence must be recorded in the change record, including the approver identity and the approval timestamp.

4. Testing and Rollback

4.1 Changes must be tested in a non-production environment before deployment.

4.2 A documented rollback plan must be attached to the change record before deployment. The rollback plan must identify the steps required to restore the previous service state.

4.3 Emergency changes may be deployed before formal approval, but must receive retrospective review within two business days.

5. Guidance

Teams should consider deploying during low-traffic windows where practical. This is a recommendation and not a mandatory control.